II. LEXICO-GRAMMAR (3.0 points)

Part 1. For questions 21-35, choose the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the correct word or phrase that best completes each of the following sentences. Write your answers in the corresponding numbered boxes on your answer sheet.

21. They didn't recognize the celebrity with his sunglasses on, _____?

A. didn't they **B.** did they **C.** didn't he **D.** did he

22. I would rather _____ my holiday in Egypt. I really like the food there.

A. taking **B.** took **C.** to take **D.** take

23. Australia has its own cultural identity, which is very different _____ that of Britain.

A. of **B.** with **C.** from **D.** on

24. Larry drove all night to get here for his sister's wedding. He _____ exhausted by the time he arrived.

A. must have been **B.** ought to have been **C.** should have been **D.** could have been

25. _____ successfully last year, the satellite has transmitted useful information back to earth.

A. Launching **B.** To launch **C.** Launched **D.** Having launched

26. Rising inflation forced many families to cut back on travel last summer; _____, local tourism boards reported a massive spike in "staycations" closer to home.

A. moreover **B.** therefore **C.** otherwise **D.** meanwhile

27. As the discussion became increasingly heated, the chairperson tried to _____ the tension by changing the subject.

A. calm down **B.** ease off **C.** break up **D.** put through

28. Designed by Frederic Auguste Bartholdi, _____.

A. the Statue of Liberty was given to the United States by the people of France

B. the United States was given the Statue of Liberty by the people of France

C. the people of France gave the Statue of Liberty to the United States

D. the French people presented the United States with a gift, the Statue of Liberty

29. _____ so remarkable is that these young students successfully developed an AI model with limited resources.

A. That makes the project **B.** What makes the project

C. The project of the students is **D.** The project of the students, which is

30. Ever since the inheritance was disputed, the two siblings have found themselves completely _____ over who has the right to the family home.

A. at loggerheads **B.** on the house **C.** at daggers drawn **D.** under their breath

31. We _____ reject any claim suggesting that we have ever manipulated or illegally altered a match ball in professional play.

A. allegedly **B.** distinctly **C.** categorically **D.** narrowly

32. Vera only started writing in her 60s, yet she became one of the most _____ writers of her generation.

A. fertile **B.** fruitful **C.** profligate **D.** prolific

33. We should work on the _____ that this plan will be successful.

A. premise **B.** base **C.** ground **D.** law

34. Many parents tend to _____ how much pressure social media places on teenagers until serious problems begin to appear.

A. persuade **B.** underestimate **C.** convince **D.** discourage

35. Mike and Joe are talking about transport in the future.

- Mike: "Do you think there will be pilotless planes?"
- Joe: "_____"

A. I'm afraid I can't.

B. What for? I don't believe you.

C. I'm glad you like it.

D. Certainly! There have been cars without drivers.

Part 2. For questions 36-45, supply the correct form of the words in brackets. Write your answers in the corresponding numbered boxes on your answer sheet.

Long before modern **(36. SCIENCE)** _____ possessed the technology to explore the furthest reaches of space, ancient astronomers devoted themselves to observing the night sky with extraordinary patience and dedication. Although their equipment was extremely primitive by today's standards, their careful observations **(37. ABLE)** _____ them to make surprisingly accurate predictions about the movement of the planets and stars. In many civilizations, the heavens were regarded with a mixture of fear and **(38. ADMIRE)** _____, as people believed that celestial events carried profound religious or political significance. The invention of more **(39. POWER)** _____ telescopes brought about a dramatic transformation in humanity's understanding of the universe. Objects that had once appeared small and **(40. CHANGE)** _____ were revealed to be dynamic systems governed by complex physical laws. Astronomers gradually realized that the universe was far larger and more **(41. COMPLICATE)** _____ than previously imagined. These discoveries challenged many traditional **(42. BELIEVE)** _____ and occasionally provoked strong resistance from those unwilling to abandon long-established ideas. Despite **(43. NUMBER)** _____ difficulties, scientific progress continued at an astonishing pace. Improved instruments allowed researchers to gather **(44. INCREASE)** _____ reliable information about distant galaxies and mysterious cosmic phenomena. Today, space exploration remains one of humanity's greatest scientific achievements, inspiring both scientists and ordinary people with a sense of wonder and curiosity about the **(45. KNOW)** _____.

Part 3. For questions 46-50, identify 5 mistakes in the following passage and correct them. Write your answers on your answer sheet. The first has been done as an example.

Line	
1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12	It is widely believed that modern technology **<u>have</u>** changed the way people communicate with each other. In recent years, social networking sites have become increasingly popular among teenagers as well as adults. Many people now spend a great number of time communicating online instead of meeting their friends face to face. Scientists are trying to discover whether this development has affected people's social skills by a positive or negative way. Although technology allows individuals to staying connected more easily, some experts believe that it may also create several serious problems. Many a student nowadays prefers sending messages online to making phone calls or writing letters. However, fewer young people can express themselves clearly in formal situations. In addition, many parents are worried that their children have become too dependent on electronic device for entertainment and communication. In conclusion, it is advisable that youngsters should make good use of modern technology in a modern world.

Example:

Line	Error	Correction
1	have	has

READING (3.0 points)

Part 1. For questions 51-60, read the following passage and choose the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the answer that best fits the blank in the following passage. Write your answers in the corresponding numbered boxes on your answer sheet.

Getting to the root of Bonsai crime

Bonsai trees have always been a source of great fascination to people. They are perfect miniatures, grown in pots small enough **(51)** _____ on a windowsill. You have to keep reminding yourself that these trees are actually real and identical to their larger cousins in all respects except their size. Rather like other small and perfectly-formed artifacts, bonsai trees **(52)** _____ quite a high price in the marketplace and so it doesn't come as a great surprise to find that they also attract the **(53)** _____ of thieves. It seems that quite a flourishing business has evolved, in which they are stolen from the homes of growers and collectors, then repotted and trimmed by unscrupulous dealers, to be sold on, **(54)** _____ good prices, to unsuspecting buyers.

One of Britain's top collectors of bonsai trees, Paul Waddington, believes that he has found a solution, however. **(55)** _____ his life's work, valued at £250,000, when burglars broke into his home one night, Paul decided to **(56)** _____ the possibilities of electronically tagging the trees he bought as a replacement. This involves injecting a microchip the size of a **(57)** _____ of rice into the trunk of each tree. Each chip is laser-etched with information **(58)** _____ is stored in a central register held by the police. Paul is quite aware that this kind of data-tagging doesn't **(59)** _____ thieves from stealing the trees in the first place, although it may increase the chances of getting them back. **(60)** _____, he's also installing a security alarm system, complete with infra-red detectors, in his home.

51. A. sitting	**B.** to sitting	**C.** to sit	**D.** sit
52. A. obtain	**B.** expect	**C.** command	**D.** charge
53. A. intention	**B.** attention	**C.** petition	**D.** location
54. A. at	**B.** on	**C.** in	**D.** of
55. A. Being lost	**B.** To have lost	**C.** Lost	**D.** Having lost
56. A. look into	**B.** set about	**C.** try out	**D.** go after
57. A. crumb	**B.** speck	**C.** bean	**D.** grain
58. A. where	**B.** when	**C.** who	**D.** which
59. A. prevent	**B.** avoid	**C.** decide	**D.** combine
60. A. However	**B.** Therefore	**C.** Moreover	**D.** Likewise

Part 2. For questions 61-70, read the following passage and fill each numbered blank with ONE suitable word. Write your answers in the corresponding numbered boxes on your answer sheet.

With automation and technological disruption accelerating globally, East Africa now finds itself at a critical crossroads. Having **(61)** _____ of the world's youngest populations, the region has an incredible opportunity to harness the potential of its youth to **(62)** _____ shifting labor market demands. Traditional and institutional training models frequently suffer **(63)** _____ content mismatches and weak employer linkages, leaving graduates ill-prepared. To address this, field pilots across Uganda, Tanzania, and Rwanda demonstrate that youth-designed, peer-led training networks effectively bridge such critical soft-skill **(64)** _____. By deploying near-peer mentors to run small-group labs, these innovative programs make abstract competencies like communication, collaboration, **(65)** _____ adaptability entirely possible through practical, real-world simulations.

(66) _____, this operational model actively uses performance as verifiable portfolios and credits that local hiring managers genuinely trust. On a regional **(67)** _____, civic hubs, donors, and employers must combine resources to embed these modular projects into university career centers and startup incubators. Believing that traditional educational institutions can solve this employment mismatch without modernizing is a textbook case of putting the cart before the **(68)** _____. Expanding these low-cost, flexible frameworks through public incentives and employer co-investment is the key to widespread economic integration in the **(69)** _____ run. By empowering youth to lead both curriculum design and instruction, East African nations can successfully convert promising local experiments into durable pipelines **(70)** _____ securely link modern learning to sustainable livelihoods.

Part 3. For questions 71-80, read the following passage and choose the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the answer to each of the questions below. Write your answers in the corresponding numbered boxes on your answer sheet.

NOW EVERYONE IS CONNECTED, IS THIS THE DEATH OF CONVERSATION?

I first noticed it in a restaurant. The place was oddly quiet, and at one table a group sat with their heads bowed, their eyes hooded and their hands in their laps. I then realised that every one, whatever their age group, was gazing at a handheld phone or tablet. People strolled in the street outside likewise, with arms at right angles, necks bent and heads in awkward postures. Mothers with babies were doing it. Students in groups were doing it. The scene resembled something from an old science fiction film. There was no conversation.

Every visit to California convinces me that the digital revolution is over, by which I mean it is won. Everyone is connected. The New York Times last week declared the death of conversation. While mobile phones may at last be falling victim to considerate behaviour, this is largely because even talk is considered too intimate a contact. No such bar applies to emailing, texting, messaging, posting and tweeting. It is ubiquitous, the ultimate connectivity, the brain wired full-time to infinity.

The MIT professor and psychologist Sherry Turkle claims that her students are close to mastering the art of maintaining eye contact with a person while texting someone else. It is like an organist playing different tunes with hands and feet. To Turkle, these people are "alone together ... a tribe of one". Anyone with 3,000 Facebook friends has none.

The audience in many theatres now sit, row on row, with lit machines in **their** laps, looking to the stage occasionally but mostly scrolling and tapping away. The same happens at meetings and lectures, in coffee bars and on jogging tracks. Psychologists have identified this as "fear of conversation", and have come up with the term "conversational avoidance devices" for headphones.

In consequence, there is now a **growing** demand for online "conversation" with robots and artificial voices. Mobiles come loaded with customized "boyfriends" or "girlfriends". People sign up with computerised dating advisors, even claim to fall in love with their on-board GPS guides. A robot seal can be picked up in online stores to sit and listen to elderly individuals talk, tilting its head and blinking in sympathy.

In his *Conversation*: A History of a Declining Art, Stephen Miller notes that public discourse is now dominated by ill-tempered disagreement, by "intersecting monologues". Anger and lack of restraint are treated as assets in public debate, in place of a willingness to listen and adjust one's point of view. Politics thus becomes a platform of rival angers. American politicians are ever more polarised, reduced to conveying a genuine hatred for each other.

All that said, the death of conversation has been announced as often as that of **the book**. As far back as the 18th century, the literary figure Samuel Johnson worried that the decline of political conversation would lead to violent civil disorder. Writing 70 years ago, George Orwell concluded that "the trend of the age was away from creative communal amusements and toward solitary mechanical ones". The philosopher Michael Oakeshott professed himself desperate to "rescue the art of conversation". Somehow we have muddled through.

The "post-digital" phenomenon, the craving for live experience, is showing a **remarkable** turnaround. The US is a place of ever greater congregation and migration, to parks, beaches and restaurants for concerts, rock festivals, ball games. Common interest groups, springing up across the country, desperately seek escape from the digital dictatorship, using Facebook and Twitter not as destinations but as route maps to meet up with real people.

Somewhere in this cultural mix, I am convinced the desire for friendship will preserve the qualities essential for a civilised life, qualities of politeness, listening and courtesy. Those obsessed with fashionable connectivity and personal avoidance are not escaping reality. They may be unaware of it but deep down they, too, still want someone to talk to.

71. What is the main topic of the passage?

A. The decline of genuine human conversation in the digital age

B. The harmful effects of social media on young people's mental health

C. The increasing popularity of artificial intelligence in daily life

D. The reasons why modern technology improves communication

72. The writer believes the main reason for the decreasing use of mobile phones is _____.

A. the realisation that it is bad manners to use them in public places

B. an overall reduction in the use of electronic devices for communication

C. the fact that people are increasingly reluctant to speak to one another

D. a general feeling that they are rapidly becoming obsolete technology

73. According to Sherry Turkle, certain people nowadays are _____.

A. incapable of forming true friendships except through social media

B. more skillful at communicating with others via music than in words

C. determined to return to a more traditional form of social structure

D. electronically connected but isolated from genuine human interaction

74. The word **<u>their</u>** in paragraph 4 refers to _____.

A. coffee bars **B.** the audience **C.** lit machines **D.** theaters

75. The word **<u>growing</u>** in paragraph 5 is closest in meaning to _____.

A. increasing **B.** declining **C.** changing **D.** caring

76. According to paragraph 6, which of the following statements is NOT TRUE?

A. Public discourse is dominated by ill-tempered disagreement.

B. People are not willing to listen to others' points of view.

C. There are no violent conflicts among American politicians.

D. Anger and lack of restraint are commonly seen in public debate.

77. The writer mentions **<u>the book</u>** in paragraph 7 as _____.

A. the basis of the theory that people would soon stop talking to each other

B. an example of something else that people wrongly predicted would disappear

C. a way of introducing the works of famous writers from earlier centuries

D. the source of information about the current state of political debate in the USA

78. The word **<u>remarkable</u>** in paragraph 8 is OPPOSITE in meaning to _____.

A. great **B.** fresh **C.** full **D.** minor

79. What point does the writer make in the last paragraph?

A. Everybody needs human contact whether they realise it or not.

B. Some traditional human values are eventually bound to disappear.

C. Nobody can escape the negative effects of the digital revolution.

D. Only those who remain polite and courteous will have friends.

80. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage?

A. The writer believes that technology will completely destroy human relationships in the future.

B. People who frequently use digital devices are less intelligent than previous generations.

C. Most psychologists agree that social media should completely be banned in public places.

D. Despite the growth of digital communication, many people still desire real human interaction.

IV. WRITING (2.0 points)

Part 1. ***Sentence transformation***

For questions 81-85, finish each of the following sentences in such a way that their meanings stay the same as the given sentences. Write your answers in the space provided on your answer sheet.

81. Jane would never agree to such an unreasonable demand.

> Never .....

82. There was such a rapid expansion of the company that it opened many new offices abroad.

> The company expanded .....

83. In spite of having very little experience, Anna managed to solve the problem effectively.

> Although Anna .....

84. Tony only accepted the job because of the high salary.

> If it had .....

85. Alternative medicine is a complete mystery to some people.

> Some people are .....

For questions 86-90, use the words given in brackets to complete the second sentence so that it has the same meaning as the first. You must use between TWO and SIX words, including the word given. Do not change the given words. Write your answers in the space provided on your answer sheet.

86. Linda feels that she doesn't fit in with her colleagues in the new office. **FISH**

> Linda feels like ..... in the new office.

87. Don't tell me the answer - it's coming to me! **TONGUE**

> The answer is ..... - don't tell me!

88. My teacher always knows what to say in every situation. **LOSS**

> My teacher is never ..... in every situation.

89. Only after having tried all methods did she call her sister for some advice. **RESORT**

> She only called her sister for some advice .....

90. When I criticised my daughter for not finishing her homework, she suddenly dissolved into tears. **WATERWORKS**

> My daughter ..... when I criticised her for not finishing her homework.

Part 2. Paragraph writing

In the digital era, students should know how to use AI tools effectively for self-study.

Write a paragraph of about 140-160 words expressing your opinion on this view.

Write your answer in the space provided on your answer sheet.

---------- HẾT ----------

Họ và tên thí sinh: ..... Số báo danh: .....

Thí sinh không được sử dụng tài liệu. Giám thị coi thi không giải thích gì thêm.